TOOL 4 • CROSS-FUNCTIONAL ALIGNMENT

The Seam Handoff Standard (Internal SLA)

> *The Seam Rule: Friction thrives in undefined handoffs between peer departments. When departments point fingers, do not mediate personal disputes. Draw a hard, contractual boundary line. Define what enters the seam, what criteria must be met, and how misses are resolved.*

PART 1: THE OPERATIONAL SEAM

SENDING TEAM (DEPARTMENT A)

RECEIVING TEAM (DEPARTMENT B)

WORK PRODUCT / DELIVERABLE MOVING ACROSS THE SEAM

PART 2: THE INTAKE STANDARD (ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA)

WHAT MUST BE TRUE FOR DEPARTMENT B TO ACCEPT THE WORK WITHOUT REWORK, DELAY, OR KICKBACK?

- ☐ Required form / fields 100% complete
- ☐ Technical specs & assets attached
- ☐ Budget / stakeholder approval documented
- ☐ Hard customer due date specified

SPECIFIC PREREQUISITE CHECKLIST & REQUIRED ARTIFACTS

PART 3: THE RESPONSE STANDARD (TURNAROUND COMMITMENT)

DEPARTMENT B TURNAROUND TIME (UPON RECEIVING COMPLETE HANDOFF)

ACKNOWLEDGMENT STANDARD (TIME TO CONFIRM RECEIPT)

PART 4: RESOLUTION PROTOCOL WHEN STANDARD IS MISSED

1ST MISS PROTOCOL (RESOLVED DIRECTLY BETWEEN PEER OWNERS WITHIN 24 HRS)

2ND MISS ESCALATION (JOINT ROOT-CAUSE AUTOPSY BEFORE DEPARTMENT HEADS)

PART 5: INTER-DEPARTMENTAL MUTUAL COMMITMENT

Department A Leader Signature
Date

Department B Leader Signature
Date